

Conclusion - What We Learned

Meta-Lessons from This Assessment

About Research:

1. **Context is king** - Models valid in one setting may fail in another
2. **Theory matters** - Description without explanation is insufficient
3. **Design determines claims** - Cross-sectional → correlation only
4. **Validation requires outcomes** - Need variation to test predictions
5. **Honesty is valuable** - Acknowledging limitations is scholarly integrity

About Academic Writing:

6. **Promise what you deliver** - Don't claim contributions you don't provide
7. **Circular reasoning is fatal** - Can't use invalid measure to validate claims
8. **Integration adds value** - Bridge literatures, don't just apply tools

About Advanced Corporate Finance:

9. **Rigor has multiple dimensions** - Theoretical, empirical, methodological
10. **Standards evolve** - Methods adequate in 1990s may be insufficient today

The Bigger Picture

This paper represents **honest, competent work that falls short of excellence** - a common situation in academic research. Understanding *why* it falls short teaches us what *excellence requires*.

